How to be a Supervillain

By Michael Fry

VICTOR: **(Prologue)** My parents fight, A LOT. *(reacts to audience)* Wait. No. Not each other. They fight other people . . . for a ***living***. My parents are supers. Supervillains, to be exact. Meet Rupert . . .

DAD: *(poses menacingly; squints as if shooting laser from his eyes)* The Red Death Ray!

VICTOR: And Olivia Spoil

MOM: *(intense karate moves)*

VICTOR: Otherwise known as . . . The Spoil Sports. I know. Pretty lame. But it works for them. Not so much for me. My name is Victor Spoil. I am 12-years-old and I was raised to be bad. *(hangs his head)* Which is a problem... *(looks up and smiles sheepishly)* when you're actually good.

INTRODUCTION

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VICTOR: **(Chpt 2)** I feel bad for Mom and Dad. They want what all supervillain parents want, *(sincerely)* They want me to grow up evil, with a burning desire to spread chaos and mayhem across the universe. But, instead, they got me – Tidy Boy. **(Chpt 4)** My parents were ***seriously*** disappointed.

MOM: *(both are working on gadgets and/or firing ray guns)* What are we going to do with him?

DAD: I have a plan!

MOM: Wait. You don't mean . . .

DAD: Now that Victor's out of school for the summer, ***he*** can take him on as an apprentice.

MOM: Seriously? ***He's*** the only option?

DAD: The Walrus turned us down. Mr. Sour Cheeks said no. Even Infectious said "Are you kidding?" *(pause)* He's our last hope. . . and he should be here any second. ***Ding Dong*** *(door opens)*

THE SMEAR: *(elderly man, cubby and balding)* The Smear is here!

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VICTOR: **(Chpt 5)** *(to audience)* Not the Smear! Anyone but the Smear. There are hundreds of supervillains. Some are cool; some are okay; a few are seriously lame . . . but the Smear is just pathetic. He once brought a jar of grape jelly to a photon saber fight!

THE SMEAR: *(uses fingers as photon sabers, the licks the jelly from them)*

DAD: **(Chpt 6)** This is our son, Victor Spoil.

VICTOR: Seriously?! There's no way I'm going to apprentice for you!

DAD: You want to be a civilian? Like Uncle Benny? He makes socks. For a living. Socks. All day. Every day. Socks.

THE SMEAR: **(Chpt 7)** Kid, you ever wonder why I am the lamest supervillain? *(intensely)* I stained Dr. Deplorable the most evil supervillain on the planet. We used to be partners. Until . . . the incident.

MOM: It was YOU?!

THE SMEAR: **(Chpt 8)** Dr. Deplorable and I worked together on a few battles against Mr. Awesome.

VICTOR: *(impressed)* The greatest hero on the planet!

MOM: *(haughtily)* I heard he has calf implants.

THE SMEAR: Dr. Deplorable had him cornered. I went in to blind him with a stain grenade... but it blew up in my hand . . .and on Dr. Deplorable's face.

THE SMEAR: The DSV (Department of Supervillains) . . .

DSV WORKER: Number 4? Number 4!

THE SMEAR: . . . banished me for twenty years, but now I can make a comeback. I'm set to battle MegaMole in Des Moines in three days.

VICTOR: The Smear laid his hand on my shoulder. Not around my shoulder. Actually ***on*** my shoulder. It felt weird. *(attitude shift)* But warm.

THE SMEAR: *(crouches to Victor's eye level)* It won't be easy, kid. It won't be glamorous and it **will** get messy. I can't guarantee fame and fortune. But I can guarantee adventure. And pie.

VICTOR: Pie? I like pie. . .

THE SMEAR: Where do you think I get the base for all my smear stains?

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VICTOR: *(looks at shoulder, to audience)* The Smear lifted his hand off my shoulder, leaving a hand-print stain. Normally, I'd freak out at something like that, but this time was different. This wasn't a stain. This was a **mark** of distinction. The mark of a supervillain's apprentice.

******* In Smear's apartment*******

THE SMEAR: **(Chpt 10)** Pay attention, kid. There's a lot to learn. *(Victor takes out a notebook and pen)* What are you doing?

VICTOR: Taking notes.

THE SMEAR: *(grabs notebook and throws it away)* First lesson: Supervillains NEVER take notes! *(looking at a row of jars)* First, let's talk stains. rotten mango and tartar sauce chutney *(hands jar to Victor, who is grossed out)* Fizzy clamato, yak milk and Walrus Wart Frappuccino.

VICTOR: Can you pick up walrus warts at Costco? *(scene shift to the garage)*

THE SMEAR: Less talking, more [evil]! *(opens garage door and proudly points out his equipment)* Stain soakers ****Splat! Splat!****

VICTOR: What about your eyes? Can you spray stains with your eyes?

THE SMEAR: *(scoffing)* No. That would be weird and really unsanitary. *(he goes on with his list)* . . . The Stain Mixer, The Flying Stain Bomber. *(they get into the car)*

VICTOR: **(Chpt 11)** Um, Mr. Smear? I was wondering about the stains. I mean, it's just a stain. How is it going to stop a superhero?

THE SMEAR: *(intense pause, then he shouts)* THEY NEVER WASH OUT! My stains . . . are feared . . . across seven continents...

VICTOR: You've fought in Antarctica?

THE SMEAR: Don't interrupt! My stains don't just stain... they stick... they goo... they get in your ears, your eyes ... THEY GET IN EVERYWHERE!!!

VICTOR: Everywhere?

THE SMEAR: Everywhere! And the worst is yet to come. Batch 487B. A superstain. . .*(ominously)* that can stain a man's soul. ****Ker-pow!****

VICTOR: **(Chpt 13)** *(to audience)* An explosion rocked the Smearmobile like a toy! We were under attack! *(to Smear)* What was THAT!

THE SMEAR: GET DOWN! *(smiling)* ***Someone*** doesn't want us in Des Moines.

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VICTOR: Then the strangest thing happened. That dumpy, grumpy, middle-aged fake supervillain had suddenly transformed into . . . The Smear . . . **(Chpt 14)** pretty darn awesome!

THE SMEAR: Victor, stay down. Stain Soaker set to 11. Let's roll! *(action sequence)* ***BLAM! LEAP! POW!***

VICTOR: *(dodging and ducking)* I'd seen a lot, but I'd never seen this. . . The Smear didn't hesitate. He took action. He was surprisingly limber for a large man.

THE SMEAR: *(battle rages on)* ***BLAM-BLAM!*** You'll never take me alive or dead *(launches rocket)* Eat stain, you miserable bag of endoskeletal goo! *(throws grenade)*

VICTOR: **(Chpt 15)** It was touch and go, back and forth, until finally the smear got the upper hand...

THE SMEAR: *(turns away from audience)* Stain in the hole! ***BOOM!*** *(Slow motion throws stain grenade at audience and turns to run)*

DR. DEPLORABLE: **(Chpt 29)** *(on loudspeaker)* You're done Smear! Say goodbye to this earthly coil and prepare to die *(coughing and hacking)*

THE SMEAR: I know that phlegm-clotted cough anywhere. That's Dr. Deplorable! **(Chpt 30)** ***Phew! Phew! Phew!*** *(bullets fly at Victor, who dodges and zigzags; the pair take cover behind a large boulder)*

VICTOR: *(terrified)* Why is he shooting at us?!

THE SMEAR: *(scared, but still The Smear)* He's mostly shooting at me! *(pause)* I'm the only one who knows his secret weakness. *(they run to the Smear Mobile)* With me out of the way, **(Chpt 36)** there'll be nothing to stop [him] from TAKING OVER THE WORLD!

DR. DEPLORABLE: **(Chpt 30)** This isn't over, Smear! I'll be back! *(coughing and hacking)*

VICTOR: He should really have that cough checked out.

THE SMEAR: **(Chpt 31)** *(as they drive away, he motions to audience)* You see those fans over there? Their lives are predictable. No winners. No losers. Just socks. Lots and lots of socks. They need us. They need good and evil. Light and dark. Real winners and real losers.

*********Transition – back in the garage preparing stain weapons*********

VICTOR: [So what's Dr. D's secret weakness?]

THE SMEAR: *(long pause, not sure if he should share)* Tickling.

VICTOR: *(in disbelief)* Dr. Deplorable's secret weakness is that he's afraid of being tickled?

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THE SMEAR: It incapacitates him. And makes him laugh. He really hates to laugh.

VICTOR: I tried to keep a straight face. I failed. We both laughed. Hard. **(Chpt 32)** With each passing day, I felt more and more comfortable around the Smear. More comfortable than I ever felt back home.

THE SMEAR: **(Chpt 35)** Go get your costume on. It's almost show time.

VICTOR: Tonight was a big night. I was excited. And nervous. Everything was going according to plan as I opened the door and discovered...

DR. DEPLORABLE: **(Chpt 36)** That's it, Smear! You're finished!

VICTOR: Dr. Deplorable was back! *(races to hide behind Smear)*

THE SMEAR: *(circling each other)* Finished?

DR. DEPLORABLE: Eliminated, erased, excised, whichever you prefer *(ridiculous moves to ramp up his elbow lasers)*

VICTOR: Why is he pointing his elbows at us?

THE SMEAR: *(cocks gun)* ELBOW LASER CATAPULTS!! Very nasty . . . *(fires)*

VICTOR: **(Chpt 45)** The battle had begun.

DR. DEPLORABLE: **(Chpt 36)** *(Dr. D dodges then fires elbow laser, which suspends Smear in midair)* ****ZAP! WOOSH!****

THE SMEAR: *(floating in mid-air, slow motion)* WHOA!!!!

VICTOR: *(to audience)* This was a moment. A moment where you just had to go for it. No matter how silly, no matter how dangerous. NOW! *(dives at Dr. D. and begins tickling him)*

DR. DEPLORABLE: *(laughing hysterically)*

VICTOR: Gotcha! *(more tickling)*

DR. DEPLORABLE: *(more laughing)*

VICTOR: *(rips off Dr. D's book and tickles his foot)*

DR. DEPLORABLE: **(Chpt 48)** *(gasping dramatically)* No!, Stop! This isn't the way (breath) it's supposed to end! *(gives up in defeat)*

VICTOR: **(Chpt 36)** Woah! It worked! **(Chpt 47)** SUPER TICKLING!

THE SMEAR: Who's awesome now?!

VICTOR: **(Chpt 49)** His weakness turned out to be my superpower?

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THE SMEAR: *(sarcastically)* Super-tickling! Who knew!

VICTOR: So, I'm THE TICKLER! *(strikes a pose with an evil laugh)*

THE SMEAR: *(shrugs)* You can pick your nose, but you can't pick your superpower.

VICTOR: I still have one question. You're a supervillain. You could have gone along with Dr. D. and taken over the world. That would have been the ultimate comeback! What stopped you?

THE SMEAR: It was you

VICTOR: Me?

THE SMEAR: You said I was awesome. Awesome people don't take over the world. Because, they don't need to. Because, you know, they're awesome. I'm a supervillain. [You] helped me see it takes a hero to make a villain. *(puts his hand over his mouth)* Did I say that out loud?

VICTOR: You **are** a hero!

THE SMEAR: Language! You kiss your mom with that mouth?

VICTOR: *(scene shifts alone on stage, he speaks to the audience)* **(Epilogue)** I now battle on the Junior Super Circuit against other beginner supervillains and superheroes like Nap Boy…

NAP BOY: Is it snack time yet?

VICTOR: . . . and The Whiner

THE WHINER: Wah! I broke a nail!

VICTOR: **(Chpt 34)** . . . Worm Boy and Smelly Feet

SMELLY FEET: *(puts his foot out to Victor's nose and he reacts)*

VICTOR: **(Epilogue)** But with Dr. Deplorable out of the way, the super battles are no longer winner takes all, but winner picks up the root beer!

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AWARD HISTORY

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